

Comparison Image Field Guide

The 16 real reference photographs still needed across all six bush-rose observations, with a title, a plain description of what to shoot, and the AI-generated placeholder currently standing in for it — so you know at a glance what "good" looks like and what's still missing.

How to use this in the field

1. Each entry below shows a Tag ID, what the photo needs to demonstrate, how to frame it, and the rose/season context it needs.
2. The image on each card is an **AI-generated placeholder**, not a real photo — it's there to show roughly what's needed, not to be matched exactly.
3. When you get a real photo, save it as that entry's Tag ID (e.g. IMG-BUSHROSE-DEADWOOD-01 . jpg) and pass it back so it can replace the placeholder in the Sourcing Brief and the Shed.
4. A few entries carry a highlighted note — read those before shooting, they flag a real gap or caveat in the research.

Source: Ask Pip – Comparison Image Sourcing Brief, v0.2 (27 September 2026). Every description below is drawn directly from that document's sourced findings; nothing here is new content.

1. Dead Versus Living Wood

Already published on the app. Closing this gap benefits a record that's live today.



IMG-BUSHROSE-DEADWOOD-01

1.1 Living cane (positive example)

- What to show** Healthy, living stem tissue.
- Framing** Close enough to show bark colour and at least one dormant bud clearly; full stem length not required.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, dormant season.

An older cane with naturally bronze-toned bark can look similar while still being alive — see the lookalike entry below (DEADWOOD-03).



IMG-BUSHROSE-DEADWOOD-02

1.2 Dead cane (positive example)

- What to show** Dead stem tissue.
- Framing** Same framing as DEADWOOD-01, ideally shot to allow a direct side-by-side comparison.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, dormant season.



IMG-BUSHROSE-DEADWOOD-03

1.3 Older living cane, bronze-toned bark (lookalike)

- What to show** The confusion risk between ageing-but-living bark and dead bark.
- Framing** Close enough to show bark tone and texture clearly.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, at least one full season old, dormant season.

A single photo may not resolve this case at all — treat an ambiguous bronze-bark case as genuinely uncertain, not something to call visually.

2. Damaged Growth

Canker has the strongest evidence of any signal in this observation — five independent sources agree on its visible signs.



IMG-BUSHROSE-DAMAGEDGROWTH-01

2.1 Canker (positive example)

- What to show** Canker — the best-evidenced form of damage in this observation.
- Framing** Close enough to show the affected bark clearly against surrounding healthy tissue.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, any season canker is visible.

A cited expert declined to diagnose a real case from photos alone — don't present this as a confident visual call.



IMG-BUSHROSE-DAMAGEDGROWTH-02

2.2 Frost damage (positive example)

- What to show** Frost damage.
- Framing** Close enough to show the visual sign clearly.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, following a frost event.

A cut-and-check is still needed to actually confirm frost damage — a photo alone isn't sufficient.



IMG-BUSHROSE-DAMAGEDGROWTH-03

2.3 Pest damage (positive half of a lookalike pair)

- What to show** Genuine pest damage: wilting, entry holes.
- Framing** Shot comparably with DAMAGEDGROWTH-04 so the contrast is visible side by side.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, active growth season — needs foliage for the wilting sign to read.

Pairs with DAMAGEDGROWTH-04 below. One commonly-cited source actually describes a harmless wasp, not a genuine pest — a real, documented mix-up worth designing the comparison around.



AI-GENERATED PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL PHOTO

IMG-BUSHROSE-DAMAGEDGROWTH-04

2.4 Harmless gall (lookalike half of the pair)

What to show A harmless gall that can be mistaken for pest damage.

Framing Shot comparably with DAMAGEDGROWTH-03.

Rose & season Established bush rose, active growth season.

FLAGGED FOR FOLLOW-UP: our placeholder shows a mossy rose gall (bedeguar gall), the most commonly pictured type — but a smooth woody stem swelling is also documented, and which one beginners actually confuse with pest damage isn't settled by the research. Worth checking against real reference photos before treating either as the answer.



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IMG-BUSHROSE-DAMAGEDGROWTH-05

2.5 Early-stage canker vs. healthy new growth (lookalike)

What to show The confusion between canker's early colour and healthy new growth's colour.

Framing Close enough to show colour and texture clearly; ideally paired directly against the canker image (DAMAGEDGROWTH-01).

Rose & season Established bush rose, early growth season.

Genuinely hard case — an expert declined to call it from a photograph alone in a real example. Present with that same honesty, not as a solved distinction.

3. Crossing or Rubbing Stems

The strongest single finding across the whole research effort (cut it, full removal) — but recognition and lookalikes are the thinnest part of the evidence base.



IMG-BUSHROSE-STEMCROSSING-01

3.1 Two canes crossing or in contact (positive example)

- What to show** Crossing or rubbing contact between two canes.
- Framing** Must show both canes AND the point where they meet — a single-cane close-up can't demonstrate crossing.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, dormant season.

No source anywhere describes what an actual rubbing wound looks like. The worn patch shown in our placeholder is an unsourced, illustrative guess — not a diagnostic feature to match.

4. Inward-Growing Stems

Most sources treat this prospectively (cut to an outward bud to prevent it) rather than as an existing defect to diagnose.



AI-GENERATED PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL PHOTO

IMG-BUSHROSE-INWARDGROWTH-01

4.1 Stem growing toward the bush's centre (positive example)

- What to show** Inward growth.
- Framing** Overhead or three-quarter angle showing the stem's direction relative to the bush's overall centre — direction matters more than the stem's own look.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, dormant season.

The only stated indicator is growth direction toward the centre — a soft, subjective standard, not a hard visual rule.



AI-GENERATED PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL PHOTO

IMG-BUSHROSE-INWARDGROWTH-02

4.2 Stem curving toward light (possible lookalike)

- What to show** Phototropic (light-seeking) curvature that could be mistaken for genuine inward growth.
- Framing** Same angle as INWARDGROWTH-01, ideally paired for direct comparison.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, wherever a light-driven curve is visible.

This distinction is our own plausible inference, not something any source actually states — worth a Founder sanity-check before treating it as a settled lookalike.

5. Weak or Congested Growth

The observation with the most usable, sourced material for comparison images.



AI-GENERATED PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL PHOTO

IMG-BUSHROSE-WEAKCONGESTED-01

5.1 A weak cane, about pencil thickness (positive example)

- What to show** Weak growth.
- Framing** Include a size reference — a pencil, ideally — in the frame; this genuinely helps with thickness judgment.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, dormant season.

“Pencil thickness” is agreed in concept but disputed nearly double between sources (6.4mm vs. 10mm) — describe it loosely, not as a precise measurement.



AI-GENERATED PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL PHOTO

IMG-BUSHROSE-WEAKCONGESTED-02

5.2 A congested bush centre (positive example)

- What to show** Congestion — too many canes crowded together.
- Framing** Wide enough to show the bush's overall centre, not a single-cane close-up.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, dormant season, before thinning.

Target cane count genuinely varies by region (roughly three to seven typical) — a judgment call, not a fixed visual threshold.



AI-GENERATED PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL PHOTO

IMG-BUSHROSE-WEAKCONGESTED-03

5.3 Healthy new cane vs. weak old cane (lookalike)

- What to show** The distinction between a naturally thin young cane and a genuinely weak old one.
- Framing** Close enough to show thorn and bark colour clearly on both canes, shot for direct comparison.
- Rose & season** One cane from the current season, one older, on the same or comparable bush.

PRIORITY #1 TO SOURCE — the strongest, most usable lookalike material found anywhere in this research, and genuinely easy to stage on any established bush. New-season canes: reddish-brown thorns and bark. Older, weaker wood: grey thorns and grey bark.

6. Main Framework to Retain

The one observation where “what can actually be judged from a photograph” has its own citable answer, rather than being inferred.



AI-GENERATED PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL PHOTO

IMG-BUSHROSE-PRUNINGFRAMEWORK-01

6.1 Overall bush shape, before pruning

- What to show** The crowded, undefined shape a bush has before pruning.
- Framing** Full-bush shot. Use the SAME angle and distance you'll use for the “after” shot below, so the change is legible at a glance.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, dormant season, immediately before pruning.

Needs an actual pruning session to capture — plan for it rather than staging on demand. Shoot this and PRUNINGFRAMEWORK-02 as a real matched pair on the same bush, same day.



AI-GENERATED PLACEHOLDER — NOT A REAL PHOTO

IMG-BUSHROSE-PRUNINGFRAMEWORK-02

6.2 Overall bush shape, after pruning

- What to show** The target open-centred, vase-shaped framework — four to six canes spread evenly round the base.
- Framing** Full-bush shot, from the SAME angle and distance as the “before” shot above.
- Rose & season** Established bush rose, dormant season, immediately after pruning — same bush, same session as PRUNINGFRAMEWORK-01.

A photo can support judging shape/outline and spotting crossing canes. It can't judge cane vigour (needs a bend/flex test) or true internal health (needs a cut to check pith colour) — don't let this pair imply anything about a cane's health.